MARYLEBONE ROSTER · LINKS DESIGNER · WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU



What it means if you…

Six ways people work the roster today, and what Even Step (recommended), In Step and Short Run would mean for each — against today's link

Prepared 4 Nov 2026 · every figure is computed from the rotas

One person, a year, cover weeks aside. Earlies and lates are counted Monday to Saturday, as Sunday is overtime. Pounds are gross, at the CEA rate of £21.49; the Pay Calculator in the app estimates a payslip. **Bold green** marks the clear best of the three for that person.

IF YOU…	TODAY	EVEN STEP	IN STEP	SHORT RUN
…prefer earlies				
Fewer, longer earlies on every link, in longer runs. Even Step's are closest to today's: none over 8h 30m, and every one is one of today's times.				
Earlies a year	88	84	84	84
Average early	7h 59m	**8h 13m**	8h 21m	8h 26m
Earlies over 8h 30m, a year	0	**0**	40	20
Earlies finishing at 13:35 or 13:45, a year	26	10	**12**	0
Weeks of earlies, or of lates, in a row	2, up to 3	5, up to 7	5, up to 7	5, up to 7
…prefer lates				
More lates on every link, in longer runs, and every closer 30 minutes to an hour shorter. Short Run's are the shortest on average.				
Lates a year	88	94	94	94
Average late, closers included	8h 29m	8h 18m	8h 10m	**8h 06m**
Longest closing shift, any day	9h 10m	**8h 10m**	**8h 10m**	8h 40m
Finishing at 23:00 or later, any day, a year	39	42	42	42
…swap earlies for lates, for the overtime				
Swapping the shortest earlies brings less overtime than today on every link. In Step keeps the most from its 13:35 or 13:45 finishes; Short Run has none of those finishes. Other swaps may still add paid time.				
A late against an early, same day, on average	32 min longer	5 min longer	11 min shorter	20 min shorter
Each 13:35 or 13:45 early swapped for the day's longest late	+34h 40m	+10h 50m	+13h 20m	none
That overtime, gross, at time and a quarter	about £930	about £290	about £360	none
…work your share of Sundays and no other overtime				
About £250 a year less on every link, gross: two more Saturdays at time and a quarter, but fewer, shorter Sundays.				
Sundays a year, at time and a half	21	20	20	20
Sunday hours a year	177	167	167	167
Premium and overtime pay, against today	—	about £250 less	about £250 less	about £250 less
…work no overtime at all				
A little better off on every link — about £80 to £90 a year, gross, from two more Saturdays at time and a quarter.				
Saturday hours a year, at time and a quarter	213	228	228	**230**
Premium pay, against today	—	about £80 more	about £80 more	**about £90 more**
…save your leave for long breaks				
Four full weeks off, Sunday to Saturday, take a day more leave on every link, though on average 14 days' leave goes as far as today. Long Break keeps them at 14 days, but is not shortlisted: it has six days in a row.				
Leave for four full weeks off, Sunday to Saturday	14 days	15 days	15 days	15 days
Days off in a row from 14 days' leave, at best	30	28	28	28
Rest-day breaks of three or four days, a year	about 13	none	none	none
Whoever you are				
What every shortlisted link gives everyone, against today.				
Full weekends off a year	10	14	14	14
Most days in a row	7, up to 9	5, up to 7	5, up to 7	5, up to 7
Shortest rest between shifts	12h 30m	**14h 35m**	**14h 35m**	14h 20m
Avoidable fatigue warnings	4, up to 5	0, up to 1	0, up to 1	0, up to 1

How these are worked out. Over 52 weeks, two turns of a 26-week link, so a design's figures are everyone's; today's, on 20 weeks, are averages. An early starts before 11:00, a late at 11:00 or after. A swap is counted on the same day: each early against that day's average late, and each 13:35 or 13:45 early — the only earlies that finish before 14:00 — swapped for that day's longest late. That is the most these particular short-early swaps could make, not a forecast: it assumes a partner for every swap, and the extra time paid at time and a quarter ("Overtime 1.25" on a payslip). The average late includes the closers; the shortlist sheet's weekday lates leave them out. The swap rows are not ranked: which link suits a swapper depends on which swaps they make. The Sunday figure is the presentations' own, to £50; the others are to £10. Leave: a working day Monday to Saturday costs a day's leave, a rest day or a Sunday none. "Up to" is the worst place a cover week's duties could fall. Fatigue warnings are reported against the ORR's good-practice list, never as pass or fail.